

HARSHAVARDHAN P

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Cybersecurity professional with 5+ years of hands-on experience in Vulnerability Assessment & Penetration Testing (VAPT) and Vulnerability Management. Currently serving as Associate Consultant at KPMG India, with prior experience as Security Analyst at Deutsche Bank (Jan 2021 – Nov 2025). Core expertise in web application penetration testing, API security testing, mobile application security (Android), network pentesting, and Qualys VMDR-based vulnerability management. Adept at identifying, analysing, and remediating security vulnerabilities aligned with OWASP Top 10, CVSS scoring, and industry-standard frameworks.

WORK EXPERIENCE

KPMG India

Associate Consultant – Cybersecurity

Nov 2025 – Present

Bangalore, India

Web Application VAPT

- Conduct manual and automated web application penetration testing for enterprise clients across financial services and technology sectors.
- Identify and exploit OWASP Top 10 vulnerabilities including SQL Injection, Broken Authentication, IDOR, SSRF, XSS, and Security Misconfiguration.
- Perform business logic testing, session management analysis, and authentication/authorisation bypass assessments.
- Deliver comprehensive VAPT reports with risk ratings, CVSS scores, proof-of-concept (PoC), and actionable remediation recommendations.
- Execute remediation validation and retesting to confirm successful closure of identified vulnerabilities.
- Support client security assessments and provide advisory to development and infrastructure teams.

Vulnerability Management (Qualys VMDR)

- Perform vulnerability analysis and remediation assessments using Qualys VMDR across Windows and Linux server environments.
- Review high and critical vulnerabilities, analyse potential system impact, and provide remediation guidance including patch updates, configuration changes, and mitigation strategies.
- Apply risk-based prioritisation using CVSS scores, asset criticality, internet exposure, and Known Exploited Vulnerabilities (KEV) framework.
- Create and track remediation tickets in ServiceNow and Jira with SLA timelines (Critical: 7 days, High: 15 days); validate fixes via re-scan and closure confirmation.
- Build weekly vulnerability dashboards covering severity trends, SLA compliance, and top vulnerable assets for security leadership reporting.

Deutsche Bank

Security Analyst

Jan 2021 – Nov 2025

Bangalore, India

Web Application Penetration Testing

- Conducted in-depth manual and automated web application penetration testing across 15+ banking and financial platforms, identifying critical vulnerabilities including OWASP Top 10.
- Performed authentication and authorisation bypass testing, session management flaws, business logic vulnerabilities, and input validation issues.
- Utilised Burp Suite Pro and OWASP ZAP for DAST scanning with configured authentication (Basic and Form-based), improving testing coverage by 30%.
- Assessed cryptographic implementations (encryption algorithms, hashing, TLS certificates) and provided actionable hardening recommendations.

- Performed secure code reviews to identify security weaknesses at source code level, contributing to early-stage vulnerability detection.
- Conducted project-level threat reviews and defined testing scope based on business requirements, reducing test gaps by 15%.
- Delivered weekly VAPT progress reports and customised security summaries for cross-functional stakeholders, reducing issue turnaround time by 20%.

API Security Testing

- Conducted security assessments on REST and SOAP APIs including authentication flaws, broken object level authorisation (BOLA), mass assignment, excessive data exposure, and rate limiting issues.
- Utilised Postman and Burp Suite Pro for API testing; mapped findings to OWASP API Security Top 10.
- Validated API security controls across integration layers for banking microservices and third-party integrations.

Other Security Activities

- Performed Android mobile application security testing using MobSF, Dex2jar, Frida, and Android Studio — analysed APKs for insecure data storage, hardcoded credentials, and weak cryptography.
- Conducted internal network vulnerability scans using Nmap and Nessus; identified misconfigurations and unpatched services.
- Executed SAST/DAST using Veracode, AppScan Standard, and SonarQube across the SDLC pipeline.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

VAPT: Web Application Pentesting, API Security Testing, Android Mobile Security, Network Pentesting, Manual Testing aligned with OWASP Top 10

Vulnerability Management: Qualys VMDR, Nessus, CVSS-Based Prioritisation, KEV Framework, Remediation Lifecycle Management

Web & API Tools: Burp Suite Pro, OWASP ZAP, Postman, Nikto

Network Tools: Nmap, Netcat, Wireshark, Nessus, OpenVAS

Exploitation: Metasploit Framework, SQLMap, Hydra

Mobile Testing: MobSF, Apktool, Dex2Jar, Frida, Android Studio

Fuzzing: FFUF, wfuzz, Dirb, Gobuster

SAST / DAST: Veracode, AppScan Standard, SonarQube

Ticketing & Reporting: ServiceNow, Jira, VAPT Reports, Vulnerability Dashboards

Security Standards: OWASP Top 10, OWASP API Top 10, CVSS, MITRE ATT&CK, NIST, PTES, CWE

Other: Threat Modelling, False Positive Validation, Risk Assessment, Secure Code Review

Operating Systems: Kali Linux, Ubuntu, Windows

Programming (Basic): Python, Bash, SQL, JavaScript

AI in Security: Prompt Injection Testing, Agentic AI Workflow Design for Security Automation, Ollama integrated with Kali Linux for recon & vulnerability analysis, LLM-aided scripting and report drafting

Web Development: Landing Page Development, HTML, CSS, JavaScript

AI & AUTOMATION INITIATIVES

- Proposed and contributed agentic AI integration concepts for automating security workflows — including AI-assisted recon, automated vulnerability triage, and LLM-driven report generation.
- Integrated Ollama (local LLM) with Kali Linux to enable AI-assisted penetration testing automation, reducing manual effort in reconnaissance and enumeration phases.
- Explored prompt injection attack vectors and contributed ideas on testing AI/LLM-integrated applications for security vulnerabilities.
- Designed concepts for agentic AI pipelines that chain security tools (Nmap, Burp Suite, Metasploit) with LLM reasoning for end-to-end automated assessments.

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- Trained for CEH – Certified Ethical Hacker (EC-Council)
- Trained Security Tester – Ethical Hacking

EDUCATION

Master of Business Administration (MBA)	2020
Sri Krishnadevaraya University, Ananthapur, Andhra Pradesh	
Bachelor of Commerce (B.Com)	2018
Vivekananda Degree College, Anantapur, Andhra Pradesh	

LANGUAGES

Telugu (Native) • English (Fluent) • Hindi (Fluent) • Kannada (Conversational) • Urdu (Conversational)